

Industry and Competitor Research

Comparable small-business bakery websites were reviewed to identify common structural and functional patterns. This research revealed that effective bakery sites typically lead with strong product photography, offer a dedicated path for custom/celebration cake orders, and prominently display contact and location details. These patterns directly informed the structure of the e-Homepage, Products, and Enquiry page in this proposal.

Target Audience Research

Given the target audience (families, students and businesses), custom cake orders were identified as a likely high-value enquiry type. For this reason, the Enquiry page was designed as a dedicated form capturing product type, size and date needed, rather than folding custom orders into a general contact form — reducing friction for the bakery's most valuable enquiries.

Design Inspiration Sourcing

The cream/brown/soft-orange palette reflects common conventions in bakery and food-service branding, chosen to evoke warmth and freshness. Georgia was selected for headings for its readability and warmth at larger sizes; Arial was paired for body text for consistent legibility across devices.

Technical Research

HTML5, CSS3 and JavaScript were confirmed as the required stack per the module brief. Godthab was selected for version control to provide a demonstrable development history. Free hosting was identified as suitable for the development phase, with paid hosting budgeted separately for deployment, reflecting realistic small-business hosting practice rather than assuming free hosting indefinitely.

Accessibility Research

WCAG 2.1 AA guidelines were reviewed to establish colour contrast and alt-text requirements, ensuring the site remains usable to as wide an audience as possible without adding unnecessary development complexity.

Sources Consulted

Nielsen, J. (2020). 10 Usability Heuristics for User Interface Design. Nielsen Norman Group. Available at: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/> (Accessed: 13 August 2026).

W3C. (2023). Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1. Available at: <https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/> (Accessed: 13 August 2026).

Mozilla Developer Network (MDN). (Nod). HTML: Hypertext Mark-up Language. Mozilla. Available at: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTML> (Accessed: 13 August 2026).